Monir Bounadi

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Education

2027 PhD in Economics, IIES, Stockholm University (expected June 2027)
- Advisors: **Torsten Persson** (main) & **David Schönholzer**

2024/25 Recognised Student, University of Oxford, hosted by **Noam Yuchtman**

2018 MSc in Econometrics, Stockholm University
- GPA 5.0/5.0

2016 BA in Philosophy, Stockholm University

2015 BSc & MSc in Mathematics, Stockholm University
- Mittag-Leffler Institute Award for Excellent MSc Thesis

Research Fields

Economic History, Economic Development, Political Economy

References

Torsten Persson
IIES, Stockholm University
torsten.persson@iies.su.se

David Schönholzer
University of Southern California
dschonho@usc.edu

David Strömberg
Stockholm University
david.stromberg@su.se

Job Market Paper

Coffeehouses and the Rise of Science (with **Jens Oehlen**)

Historians have long credited coffeehouses, venues for conversation where strangers met across social ranks, with fostering scientific contacts and activity during the Scientific Revolution. We test this claim in seventeenth-century London. Relying on newly geocoded records and a staggered event study across parishes, we find that the opening of the first coffeehouse in a parish is followed by a persistent increase in applied scientists and scientific instrument shops. Effects are concentrated among applied scientists with weak family ties to Oxford and Cambridge. Social connections that link craft skill to theory increase, and new shops turn toward experimental instruments. Across European cities in the seventeenth century, we similarly find that the numbers of applied mathematics titles and scientific instrument makers rise after a city's first coffeehouse, relative to cities of similar size and growth. In a quantitative urban model calibrated to our parish- and city-level estimates, coffeehouses account for 31 percent of London's applied scientists in the half century after the first one opened in 1652. These findings show that social institutions can raise the production and use of knowledge by broadening access to intellectual exchange beyond formal academic networks.

Working Papers

Learning to Participate: The Effects of the First Female Teachers (with **Mattias Folkestad**)

How does opening a profession to a previously excluded group shape the next generation? From 1859, Sweden allowed women to teach in elementary schools. We digitize teacher registers and 350,000 signatures from the 1913–14 suffrage petition, linking them to full-count censuses. Exploiting the staggered timing of districts' first female hire, we show that women exposed to female teachers as schoolgirls were 23 percent more likely to sign the petition and 9 percent more likely to work outside other people's homes. IV estimates using nearby women's teacher seminaries suggest early female-hiring districts also had stronger suffrage organizations and more women voting in person.

Wealth Confiscation and Elite Persistence: Evidence from the Great Reduction (with **Jonatan Riberth**)
This paper studies how far a wealth shock persists across generations and whether it erodes status by examining the largest confiscation in Swedish history: the Great Reduction of 1680, which took half the nobility's landed wealth. Linking noble genealogies to manor ownership across the Swedish realm, we compare descendants of nobles who lost manors with those of observably similar nobles who did not. Manor ownership falls sharply and stays lower four generations later, by more than mobility correlations predict. Yet careers, marriages, human capital, and demographic outcomes barely move, though they respond strongly to descent from the political elite.

Work in Progress

Return from Mecca: Pilgrimage and Political Islam in Indonesia, 1874–2014

Co-Ethnic Mentors: Historical Evidence from New York City Neighborhoods (with **Artschil Okropiridse**)

Other Writing

Lärarinnorna som banade väg för kvinnors frigörelse (with **Mattias Folkestad**), *Ekonomisk Debatt* 53 (3): 22–28, 2025

De utmanade den manliga statsmaktens legitimitet, *Liberal Debatt* 2023 (6), 2023

Weather and Conflicts in Afghanistan, *Expert Group for Aid Studies, Sweden*, EBA Working Paper, June, 2018

Bör mainstreamekonomin reformeras?, *Ekonomisk Debatt* 45 (3): 70–74, 2017

Grants and Scholarships

2025	Research grant, Lars Hierta Memorial Foundation, 30,000 SEK (≈€2,700)
2021–24	Research grants, Carl Mannerfelt Foundation, 153,400 SEK (≈€14,000)
2021	PhD exchange scholarship, Tom Hedelius Foundation, 499,000 SEK (≈€45,000)
2021	Research grant, Karl Staaff Foundation, 75,000 SEK (≈€7,000)
2019	PhD scholarship, Erik Johan Ljungberg Foundation, 125,000 SEK (≈€11,000)

Presentations

2026	Applied Young Economists' Webinar; ASWEDE Conference (scheduled); CEPR Paris Symposium (scheduled); EAYE Annual Meeting, University of the Basque Country; Economic Inequality and Political Institutions in the Nordic and Baltic Regions, c. 1400–1900, Uppsala University (co-author); IIES, Stockholm University; Lund University (scheduled); RIDGE Forum, University of the West Indies (co-author); SIOE Conference, INSEAD Fontainebleau; TSE; University of Gothenburg (co-author); Uppsala Workshop in Economic History; Workshop on Growth, History and Development, University of Southern Denmark; Workshop on Wealth Inequality, Intergenerational Mobility, and Equality of Opportunity, WU Wien (co-author, scheduled); Yale-UB HPE Workshop, University of Barcelona; Zurich Workshop in AI & Applied Economics (co-author)
2025	Danish HPE Workshop, University of Southern Denmark (co-author); IIES, Stockholm University; SUDSWEC, Stockholm School of Economics
2024	Arthur Lewis Lab, University of Manchester (co-author); IIES, Stockholm University (co-author); New Perspectives on Swedish Political History, Stockholm University; SUDSWEC, Stockholm University (co-author); Summer 2024 IOG-BFI Conference (co-author); Swedish Conference in Economics, Lund University (co-author); University of Oxford
2023	ASWEDE Conference; Harvard University PE Tea (co-author); Institute of Urban History, Stockholm University; SUDSWEC, Uppsala University; Swedish Register-Based Research Summit

Research Assistantships

2018/19 Research Assistant for **David Seim** & **David Strömberg**, Stockholm University
2018 Research Assistant at the Expert Group for Aid Studies, Sweden
2017 Research Assistant for **Nils Karlson**, Ratio Institute, Stockholm

Teaching Assistantships

2022 Econometrics II, Stockholm Doctoral Course Program in Economics
2019–22 Mathematics II, Stockholm Doctoral Course Program in Economics
2019 Empirical Methods in Economics 3 (BSc), Stockholm University
2018/19 Econometrics 3b: Time Series Data (MSc), Stockholm University
2017–19 Econometrics I (MSc), Stockholm University
2015–19 10+ BSc Mathematics & Statistics courses, Stockholm University, KTH, & MHS Karlberg

Academic Service

2021–23 Organiser, Applied Econometrics Reading Group, IIES, Stockholm University
2015/16 Vice President, Council of the Faculty of Arts, Stockholm University
2015/16 Student Representative, Board of the Faculty of Arts, Stockholm University

Software

Stata, R, Python, ArcGIS, QGIS, MATLAB, Mathematica, SPARQL, Git, LaTeX

Personal Information

Citizenship: Swedish
Languages: Swedish (first language), English (fluent), Moroccan Arabic (basic)

Career Breaks

2025–26 Parental leave (7 months)
2022–23 Parental leave (8 months)